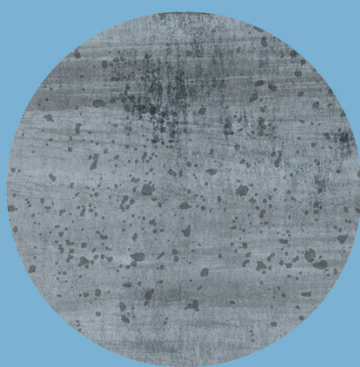
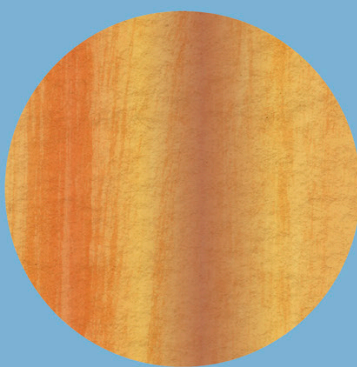




Mercury

Mercury is the smallest planet, and it is closest to the sun. It is covered in craters.



Venus

This planet is almost as big as the Earth. It is the hottest planet, with a thick **atmosphere** that traps heat. It also has clouds that rain sulfuric acid!



Earth

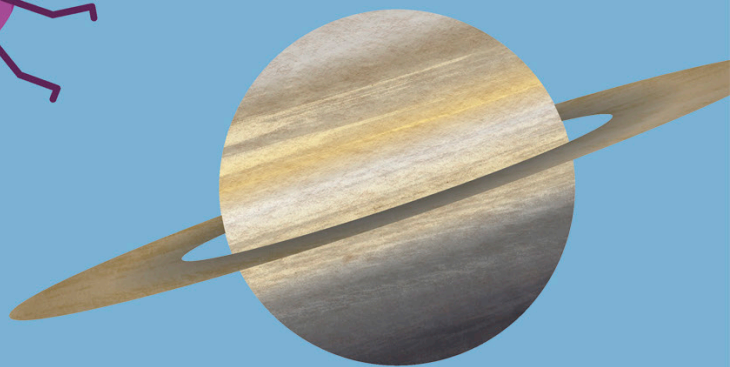
Our planet, Earth, is a special place. It's the only planet with oceans of water, plenty of oxygen in its atmosphere, and living things.



Astronomers have found planets around other stars in deep space. Some may be able to support life.

The planets

Earth is one of eight planets that orbit, or go around, the sun in our solar system. Mercury, Venus, Earth, and Mars are rocky planets. Jupiter, Saturn, Uranus, and Neptune are giant planets made mostly of gas.



Saturn

The second-largest planet, Saturn, has beautiful rings made up of pieces of ice and rock. Saturn has 82 moons—poor old Mercury has none.

The sun

Planet parade

As the planets whiz around the sun, they're held in place by the sun's **gravity**. The rocky planets are the closest to the sun.

Mercury

Venus

Earth